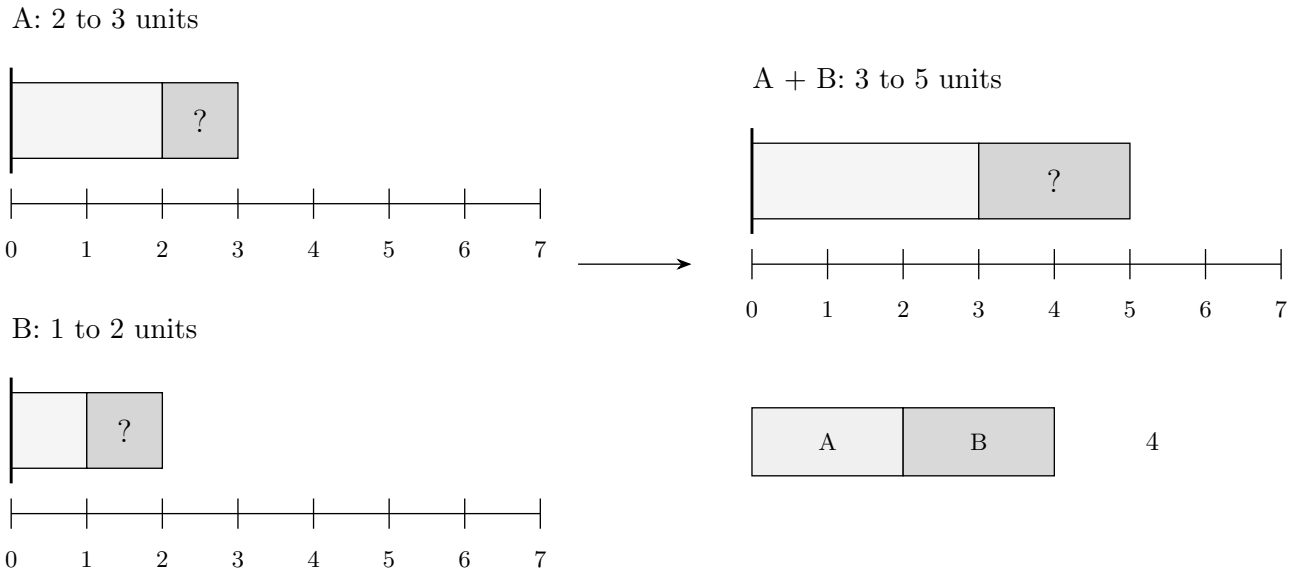
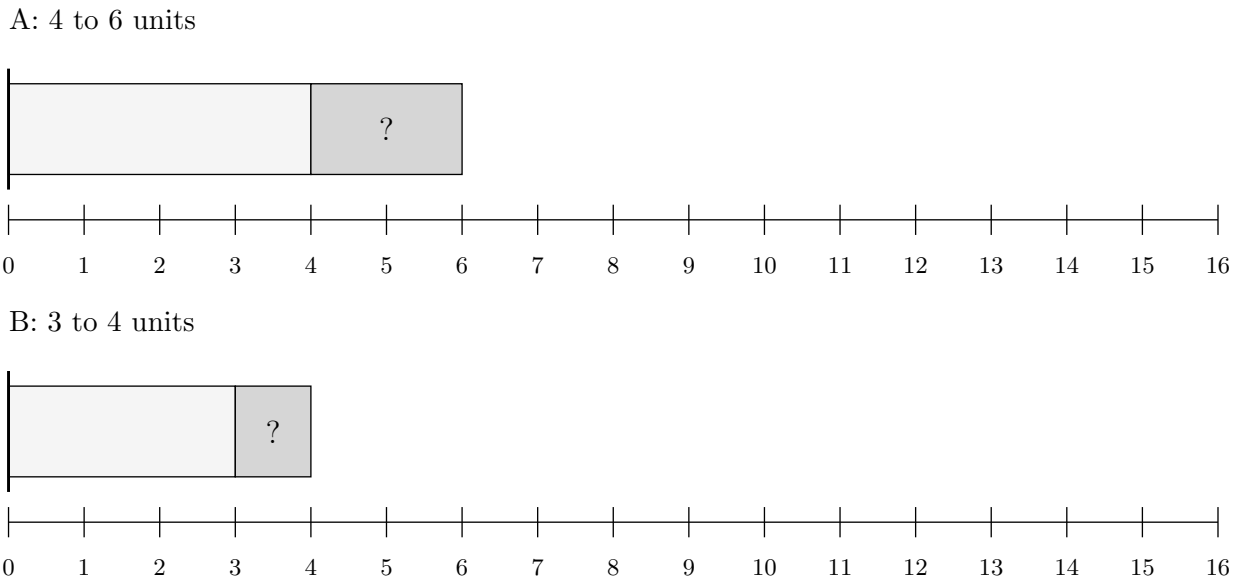
A hidden end can be anywhere in its gray band, including the edges. Each trial may use new lengths. Join strips end to end from 0, with no gap or overlap.

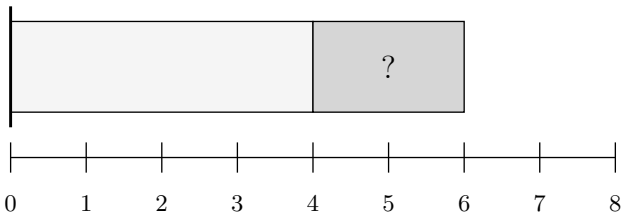


Problem 1: Make the shortest and longest joins with these strips. Can you make a join ending exactly at 8?

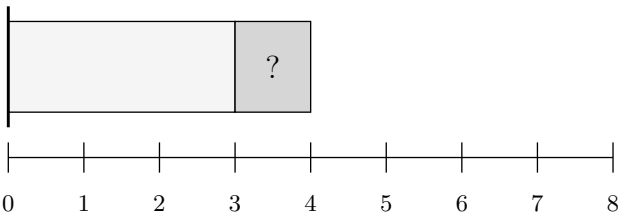


Problem 2: Try A with B, C with D, and E with F; which pairs always reach 8? Let a friend try to defeat your choices.

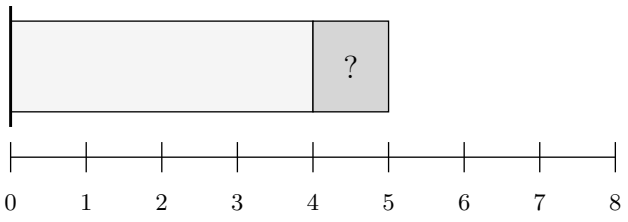
A: 4 to 6 units



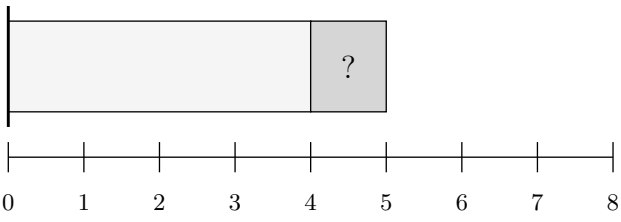
B: 3 to 4 units



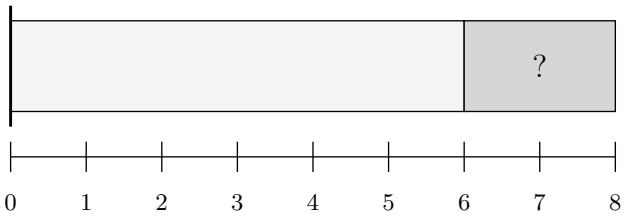
C: 4 to 5 units



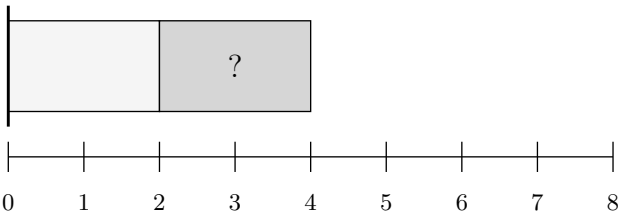
D: 4 to 5 units



E: 6 to 8 units



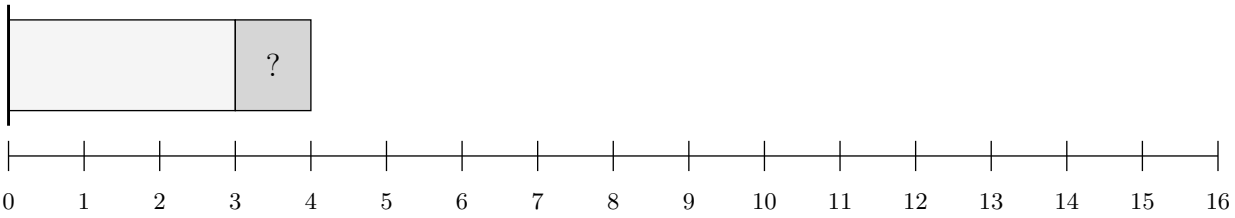
F: 2 to 4 units



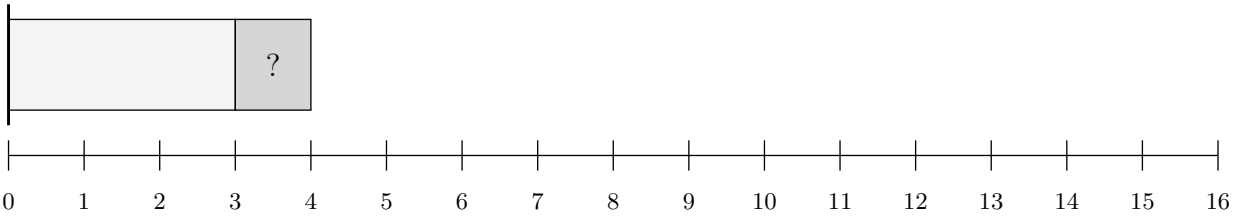
Reaching 8 includes ending at 8.

Problem 3: Pick a card for B so the join always reaches 7 and fits within 9. Try to break your choice with different allowed strips.

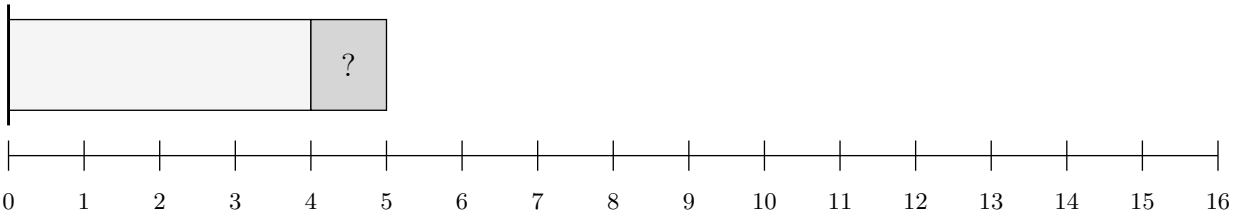
A: 3 to 4 units



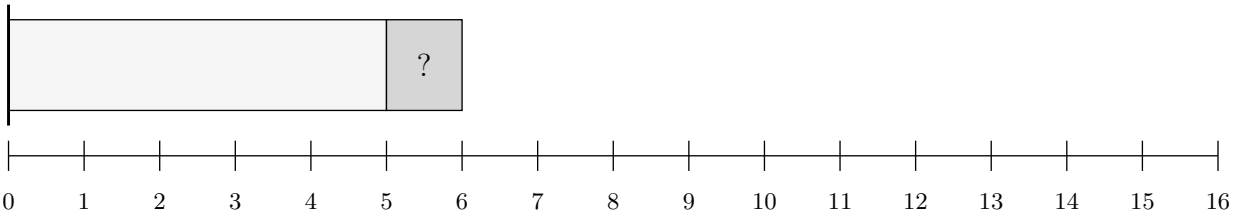
B: 3 to 4 units



B: 4 to 5 units



B: 5 to 6 units



Fitting within 9 includes ending at 9.